

Q. How do you generate your revenue from your partner ecosystem?

A. Our revenue model is straightforward. Partners may sell subscriptions for the complete VNClagoon stack or for individual products, and we provide them with an attractive margin. Our subscription fees cover product maintenance, current versions, and basic support. We explicitly state that we are not a SaaS provider and have no intention to become one. We are cloud-native and SaaS-native, but we strictly operate through indirect channels. Our partners are our direct customers, ensuring we never compete with them in the SaaS space. Significant customers may request our involvement in kickstarting a project, but our focus is on involving partners early on for operations, consulting, services, help desk, and third-party integrations. As developers, our focus is on the future, and we commit to no interference with any partner's operational aspects.

Q. When your partners customise your product and sell it to other people, does the pricing change, and if it does, how?

A. Partners utilise our core suite or select components based on their needs. The suite is highly modular, allowing them the flexibility to choose specific products rather than adopting the entire suite. They can start with one product and, if they identify a need for additional features catering to their target audience, they are encouraged to develop those components. We invite them to contribute and innovate freely. If they wish to collaborate with us for selling the developed component in other territories, a percentage of the list price is negotiable to cover administrative, sales, and other associated costs. This concept is akin to platforms like the Apple marketplace.

Alternatively, if partners prefer to develop features exclusively for their

customers without reselling through our platform, they are welcome to do so independently. We refer to this approach as the VNCfactory, emphasising our commitment to fostering a collaborative development platform. Partners are encouraged to build and provide customers with enhanced solutions tailored to their specific needs, recognising that regional variations may result in unique requirements for different markets. Only in cases where we are involved in reselling do discussions about the marketplace and associated terms come into play. This vision underpins the entire product development strategy, positioning it as not just a product but also as a versatile development platform.

Q. Do you provide any sort of support? If yes, are you monetising that support model?

A. We acknowledge the need to support our personnel, including support and consultants, for tasks like setting up substantial infrastructures. However, our aim is to swiftly transition such responsibilities to our partners, who provide support in 90% of cases. Considering this, we've explored ways to simplify our partners' lives. Our VNClagoon stack installs within an hour, ready for use on any Kubernetes flavour, whether it's Google Cloud, Amazon Cloud, IBM Cloud, or an on-premises Kubernetes in a data centre. This optimised deployment allows for rapid recovery in the event of a disaster, with crucial components up and running within 10 minutes. This is our unique selling point, as hardly any other solution in the market achieves such swift deployment, which is beneficial for our partners, including telcos, SaaS providers, governments, and large enterprises. With standard technologies and a fully open source platform, operators or DevOps teams can quickly grasp the installation and setup, taking only about a few hours — in multi-node environments — with minimal support from our end.

Q. What kind of partners are you looking for in India?

A. We seek partners who serve customers with security concerns, such as entities working for government clients, banks, insurance companies, and businesses dealing with customer data that requires strict security and confidentiality measures. We had earlier partnered with an entity based in India that offered hosting services. Our partners include businesses of varying sizes – small, medium-sized, and large enterprises, as well as private consumers seeking communication and collaboration products. Whether it's an alternative to Microsoft Teams, Microsoft Exchange, or Jira for project management, our partners offer diverse solutions for the unique needs of their clientele.

Q. How has the response been from your target market, and how do you plan to expand it?

A. We have a compelling example here in Europe, where we started as a company. However, our aspirations extend beyond Europe, and we are currently receiving numerous requests from the Middle East. An interesting development is the rapidly growing influence of the BRICS nations. India, being a part of BRICS, has played a significant role from the outset, contributing to this expansive and emerging market. Notably, an increasing number of nations have expressed interest in joining BRICS. Some of these nations are approaching us with the proposition of establishing a sovereign IT environment tailored for their specific communication and collaboration needs. This ongoing development is truly fascinating.

Q. What role does India play in your operations?

A. VNC heavily relies on our exceptional team members in India, as our journey began around 11 years ago, and at that time, India was among the few countries with the requisite